“We’ll look into it” can mean yes, no or not yet





01

Hear the soft no

検討します, “we’ll consider it”, is sometimes a polite no.

In Korea, decisions still move through a hierarchy you don’t see.



検討します

Yes? No? Not yet?

Habits that get decisions



Ask closed — “Can we go with B?”, not “Thoughts?”

Write it up — Same-day notes with decisions and names

Ask who else — The person in the room may not approve

Work the way they work



Channel

KakaoTalk in Korea. Email as the record in Japan

Minutes

Gijiroku are standard. Send your own summary

Lead time

Consensus takes longer. Rushing gets caution

02

Name it and date it

A named, dated decision is easier to act on than a thumbs-up in chat.

Key visual: option B

Approved by: Tanaka-san, 12 March

Next: copy check by 15 March



Clear decisions are a courtesy to both sides.

Taking a Western brand into Japan, Korea or wider APAC?

Give me a shout

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